



www.cgaux.org

FLOAT PLAN

INSTRUCTIONS: Complete this plan before you go boating and leave it with a reliable person who can be depended upon to notify the Coast Guard, or other rescue organization, should you not return or check-in as scheduled. If you have a **change of plans** after leaving, be sure to notify the person holding your Float Plan.

Do NOT file this plan with the Coast Guard.



www.uscgboating.org

VESSEL

IDENTIFICATION:

Name & Port _____
 Document / Registration No. _____
 Year / Make _____
 Length _____ Type _____
 Hull & Trim Color _____
 Unique Feature(s) _____

COMMUNICATIONS: (Check all onboard & supply requested information)

Radio Call Sign: _____
 DSC MMSI Number: _____
 Cockpit Radio-1: Type _____ Ch / Freq. Monitored _____
 Cockpit Radio-2: Type _____ Ch / Freq. Monitored _____
 Handheld Radio: Type _____ Ch / Freq. Monitored _____
 Cell Phone: _____
 Other _____

PROPULSION:

Primary: _____ hp _____ Fuel Capacity _____
 Auxiliary: _____ hp _____ Fuel Capacity _____

NAVIGATION: (Check all onboard)

☐ Maps ☐ Charts ☐ Compass ☐ Navigation Rules
☐ GPS ☐ Radar ☐ Loran C ☐ _____

SAFETY & SURVIVAL

PFDs: (Specify quantity)

____ Type I _____ Mirror (Day only)
 ____ Type II _____ Red or Orange Distress Flag (Day only)
 ____ Type III _____ Orange Smoke, Floating (Day & Night)
 ____ Type IV _____ Red Distress Flares (Day & Night)
 ____ Type V _____ Electric distress light (Night only)

VISUAL DISTRESS SIGNALS: (Specify quantity)

AUDIBLE DISTRESS SIGNALS:

☐ Horn / Whistle
☐ Bell
☐ _____

MEDICAL/HEALTH:

☐ First Aid
☐ Food/Water _____ (days)
☐ _____

GROUND TACKLE: (Check all onboard & supply requested information)

☐ Working Anchor - line length _____ ft.
☐ Storm Anchor - line length _____ ft.

OTHER GEAR:

☐ Survival Suit(s) ☐ Flashlight / Searchlight
☐ Safety Harness ☐ Life Rafts: _____ (Qty) Lifeboats: _____ (Qty)
☐ Sea Anchor ☐ EPIRB Freq: _____
☐ Fire Extinguisher ☐ _____

PERSONS ON BOARD

OPERATOR:

Name	Age	Sex	Notes (Medical Condition, Can't Swim, etc.)
_____	_____	_____	_____
Address _____			Home Phone _____
City _____ State _____ Zip code _____			Drivers License _____
Vehicle (Year, Make & Model) _____			License No. _____
Where will trailer be parked? _____			License No. _____

PASSENGERS:

Name & Home Phone	Age	Sex	Notes (Medical Condition, Can't Swim, etc.)
1. _____	_____	_____	_____
2. _____	_____	_____	_____
3. _____	_____	_____	_____
4. _____	_____	_____	_____
5. _____	_____	_____	_____

ITINERARY

	DATE	TIME	LOCATION	MODE OF TRAVEL	REASON FOR STOP	CHECK-IN TIME
Depart						
Arrive						
Depart						
Arrive						
Depart						
Arrive						
Depart						
Arrive						
Depart						
Arrive						

Attach Supplemental Itinerary if additional space required.

Contact 1 _____ Phone Number _____

Contact 2 _____ Phone Number _____

If you have a genuine concern for the safety or welfare of any persons on board this vessel, who have not returned or checked-in within a reasonable amount of time, then follow the step-by-step instructions on the **Boating Emergency Guide** included with this plan, or on the World Wide Web at:

<http://www.uscgaux.org/~floatplan/BoatingEmergencyGuide.htm>

BOATING EMERGENCY GUIDE

You will need the following items before you begin: 1) The **Float Plan**, if one was given to you; 2) **Pen** or **Pencil**; 3) Clean sheet of **paper** or **writing tablet**; and 4) **Telephone Directory**.

Step 1

Is there a genuine concern for the safety or welfare of any persons on board the vessel, who have not returned or checked-in within a reasonable amount of time?

If YES, continue with **Step 2**. If NO, then **Stop**. No further action is required at this time.

Step 2

Were you given a prepared Float Plan by anyone onboard the vessel?

If YES, continue with **Step 3**. If NO, then go to **Step 5**.

Step 3

On the Float Plan, locate the two contact lines, below the "Itinerary" at the bottom of the Float Plan. Call the telephone number of Contact-1.

IF:	THEN:						
A person answered the phone...	Take notes during your conversation.						
	1. Let the person know that you are responding to a late return or check-in by the individuals designated on the Float Plan.						
	2. Determine if the person you are talking to, or anyone else at that location, has recently had contact with anyone on the vessel, and when and where that contact occurred.						
	3. Are you still concerned about the safety or welfare of any persons on board the vessel?						
	<table><tr><th>IF:</th><th>THEN:</th></tr><tr><td>Yes</td><td>Continue with Step 4.</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>Stop. No further action is necessary at this time.</td></tr></table>	IF:	THEN:	Yes	Continue with Step 4 .	No	Stop . No further action is necessary at this time.
IF:	THEN:						
Yes	Continue with Step 4 .						
No	Stop . No further action is necessary at this time.						
Otherwise...	Continue with Step 4 .						

Step 4

Call the telephone number for Contact-2.

IF:	THEN:						
A person answered the phone...	Take notes during your conversation.						
	1. Let the person know that you are responding to a late return or check-in by the individuals designated on the Float Plan.						
	2. Determine if the person you are talking to, or anyone else at that location, has recently had contact with anyone on the vessel, and when and where that contact occurred.						
	3. Are you still concerned about the safety or welfare of any persons on board?						
	<table><tr><th>IF:</th><th>THEN:</th></tr><tr><td>Yes</td><td>Continue with Step 6.</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>Stop. No further action is necessary at this time.</td></tr></table>	IF:	THEN:	Yes	Continue with Step 6 .	No	Stop . No further action is necessary at this time.
IF:	THEN:						
Yes	Continue with Step 6 .						
No	Stop . No further action is necessary at this time.						
Otherwise...	Continue with Step 6 .						

Step 5

Take a moment to jot down the facts you know about each item in the checklist below:

Do not speculate! Speculation of a fact may mislead search and rescue personnel and add to the overall search and rescue time, adversely affecting the outcome.

- ☐ Period of time the vessel has been overdue.
- ☐ Purpose of the trip or voyage.
- ☐ Description of vessel (color, size, shape, etc.)
- ☐ Vessel's departure point and destination.
- ☐ Places the vessel planned to stop during transit.
- ☐ Navigation equipment on board (such as GPS, Compass, Maps, Charts, LORAN C, etc.)
- ☐ Survival equipment on board (life jackets, EPIRB, flares, etc.)
- ☐ Number of people on board the vessel, as well as personal habits e.g. dependability, reliability, etc.
- ☐ Was the vessel already moored, or did a vehicle tow it to the location?
- ☐ License plate number and description of the vehicle of the towing and/or crew transport vehicle.
- ☐ Communications equipment on board including radio frequencies monitored, cellular telephone numbers of people aboard.
- ☐ Additional points of contact in the area.
- ☐ Were there any pending commitments (work, appointments, etc.)?

Continue with **Step 6**.

Step 6

1. Contact your local Law Enforcement agency.
2. Let the dispatcher know that you are responding to a late return or check-in by the persons on board.
 - a. The dispatcher will guide you from there. The dispatcher will provide you with the necessary contact or agency connection (if one was not given on the Float Plan) to get a Search And Rescue (SAR) mission started. This is usually handled this way because it puts you closest to the agency conducting the rescue mission, eliminating an unnecessary middleman.
 - b. The dispatcher will let you know if they would like a follow-up call from you on the outcome.
3. The dispatcher will instruct you from there.

Continue with **Step 7**.

Step 7

Be patient... you've done everything you can possibly do for now. Stay off of the phone, so emergency personnel can contact you with additional information and/or questions concerning the Search And Rescue (SAR) effort.

End of Guide